Application Period Opens, Delta Presents to KSE Deans, and Other Updates from July 2026

The Delta Engineering program at Kyiv School of Economics (KSE) has less than two months until its inaugural semester. This July, the Delta team hosted their final admissions events of the season, and they reconnected with KSE leaders.

Presenting the curriculum

On July 15, the Delta Engineering team presented a substantial plan for their new undergraduate program. KSE deans, academic directors, and others were in attendance.

Delta faculty showed how their program will create engineers who can define problems, design solutions, and take responsibility for real systems. They described the courses that they had designed with input from Olin faculty, such as Quantitative Engineering Analysis, Bio-Inspired Design, and Innovative Design. They explained how each course uses project-based learning, connections to the real world, teamwork, and co-design. Partner-students testified about their role in the program's development. One partner-student expressed, "it's a good feeling — waking up every day, wondering, *what will I create?*"



The presentation led to meaningful discussion. The team will continue sharing their curricular model with the KSE community in the next academic year. KSE faculty will have two weeks of training sessions in July and August. Delta faculty are excited to discuss pedagogy and create deeper bonds with other KSE faculty.

Applications officially begin through Ukrainian national web portal

In Ukraine, applying to college is done via a centralized system owned by the Ministry of Education. The entire process is public. It can be tracked online, including student test scores, applications, and more. This year, applicants are going through these steps:

- **The NMT:** *(May 20 – June 25)* Applicants take the National Multi-subject Test (NMT), a standardized admissions test for higher education. NMT results are available in early July.

- **Applications:** *(July 19 – July 31)* Applicants use the Ministry web portal to apply to higher education institutions. They rank their top ten choices.

- **Placement Algorithm:** *(Early August)* The Ministry executes an algorithm to determine who qualifies for each program. They consider NMT scores, college-specific entry requirements, regional preferences, and more. In Ukraine, the Ministry of Education funds some seats (called budget seats) for students at private and public higher education institutes. The number of

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budget seats for incoming students varies yearly for each program. The Ministry decides who is recommended for each budget seat as part of the placement algorithm.

- **Enrollment:** *(Mid-August)* The Ministry informs applicants of where they were accepted and whether they were recommended for a budget seat. If an applicant declines a budget seat, they forfeit the state funding — it does not transfer to other institutions.

Applicants who do not get a budget seat can pay for enrollment with the help of school financial grants, scholarships, loans, need-based financial aid, or at their own family expense.

KSE has a set number of licenses from the Ministry for Bachelor's students. The Delta program expects a class of 30 students in September 2026. Some seats are dedicated to state budget seats, KSE financial grant seats, financial aid seats, and self-paid seats. KSE informs applicants of whether they would be awarded a financial grant before the application period opens. Applicants are more likely to rank Delta as their top choice if they know they would get financial grant.

On-campus Challenge Days help Delta find applicants who fit culturally

In June and July, KSE Delta hosted five Challenge Days for applicants. Challenge Days — the equivalent of Candidates' Weekends at Olin — were multi-hour, in-person events. These days helped KSE Delta find applicants who would thrive in an innovative program and help it grow.

For the main activity, prospective students were grouped into small teams. They were given crafting supplies (wooden sticks, glue guns, rubber bands, etc.), and they were asked to create something that can store energy and launch a ball from their table into a net in the center of the room. Throughout the activity, unexpected twists made the task more difficult, like ten minutes without talking, or removal of their most-used item (glue guns). After the group activity, there was clean-up and then individual interviews.



Delta faculty used individual interviews and observation rubrics at Challenge Days to asses students for financial grants. This information complemented NMT scores.

Challenge Days also served as a statement to applicants. The activity emphasized teamwork and the design process. Dozens of students felt drawn to this philosophy and said they will rank Delta as their top choice of college. Hesitant students, on the other hand, had the opportunity to engage in conversation about theory and practice in undergraduate engineering.

Kyiv School of Economics launches two engineering Bachelor's programs

Kyiv School of Economics launched its first Bachelor's programs (in economics and IT) in 2020 as a part of a wartime recovery initiative. The school has blossomed over the last few years; it now offers

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eight Bachelor's programs. Because engineering competencies are critical for the future of infrastructure, technology, energy systems, and defense solutions in Ukraine, KSE is launching two Bachelor's programs for engineering in the fall — Delta is not the only one.

The sibling program to Delta Engineering is called Engineering of Innovative Manufacturing. It is funded by Fire Point, a leading Ukrainian defense manufacturing company. Both Delta and Innovative Manufacturing will produce industry-ready graduates, however, they will achieve that goal in different ways. The Fire Point-sponsored program is interested in recruiting top-scorers on the NMT. They hope to quickly help students apply their existing math and physics knowledge to manufacturing problems.

Delta, on the other hand, is designing a transformational educational experience. Delta also has an NMT cutoff score for acceptance, but they also care about finding students who will embody the principles of the program and set the tone for years to come.

In June, while students were taking a traditional entrance exam for Innovative Manufacturing, Delta was hosting its first Challenge Day across the hall — bustling with activity and laughter. After finishing up Challenge Days, Delta Program Manager Rebecca Brosseau reflected, "it feels good for the team to know the right students are out there, and we haven't even scratched the surface of the country yet."

Delta has also begun to secure industry partnerships for student projects. They are currently in talks with a Ukrainian prosthetics company, Esper Bionics, and the war trauma rehabilitation center Superhumans.

Report by Adam Coppola
On behalf of KSE-Olin partnership principals
Photos by Rebecca Brosseau
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